AETHERUM.AI

Crypto-Collateralized Lending Infrastructure for Credit Unions

AI-powered risk scoring · BitGo custody · Plaid connectivity · Sardine compliance

Pre-Seed Round | $1M | $8M SAFE Cap

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$1T+

Institutional Crypto Market

5,000+

Credit Unions in the US

$1.2M

Target ARR Year 1

THE PROBLEM

Credit Unions Are Losing Members to Crypto Fintechs

50M+ Americans hold crypto. When they need liquidity, they leave their credit union.

😤 Members Leave

CU members sell their crypto or go to Nexo/Coinbase for loans — taking their deposits with them

⚠️ No Risk Infrastructure

Credit unions have no way to assess crypto collateral risk — no scoring, no LTV tools, no compliance framework

🏛️ Regulatory Gap

NCUA has no clear guidance for crypto lending, leaving CUs paralyzed despite member demand

📉 Losing the Next Gen

Younger members with crypto wealth are choosing digital-native banks over their local credit union

62% of credit union members under 40 say crypto services would increase their loyalty — CUNA 2024

THE SOLUTION

Aetherum: Plug-and-Play Crypto Lending for Credit Unions

We are the software layer. The CU owns the relationship, the collateral, and the revenue.

1

CU Member Applies

Deposits BTC/ETH as collateral

2

DACS Scores the Risk

AI calculates LTV, risk tier, APR

3

BitGo Holds Custody

CU's own BitGo account — not ours

4

Plaid Verifies Income

Bank connectivity for underwriting

5

Loan Issued

USD disbursed 8-12% APR

✓ **No Tax Event**

Members borrow instead of sell

✓ **Keep Crypto Upside**

Collateral stays in their name

✓ **CU Earns +48% More**

Staking boosts $8K to $11.8K/loan/yr

✓ **NCUA Compliant**

Full audit trail via BitGo

CORE DIFFERENTIATOR

DACS: Dynamic Asset Credit Scoring

Patent-pending AI scoring system — the only crypto-native credit score built for institutional lending

DACS Score

708

GOOD • Risk Tier 1.5 • Max LTV 60%

Poor	Fair	Good	Excellent
300	580	670	750

Live API — scores update in real time

Demo: test-app.aetherum.ai

The 5 DACS Pillars

40% — **Portfolio Value**
Crypto holdings size & diversification

35% — **Asset Quality**
Security tier, volatility rating

25% — **Stability Index**
Account age, holding duration

+TAM — **Financial Profile**
Plaid bank data bonus

Output — **Risk Tier**
1.0–3.0 → LTV, APR, max loan

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

A $1T Institutional Crypto Infrastructure Market

We start with credit unions — the most trusted, underserved financial institutions in America

5,000+

Credit Unions

$250-500K ACV

Primary target — distribution channel

1,500

Community Banks

$250K-1M ACV

Expansion Year 2+

2,000

DeFi Protocols

$250-500K ACV

Risk & compliance tooling

30,000+

Wallet Services

$50-150K ACV

DACS API licensing

Year 1 target: 10 credit unions × 100 loans/mo × $1K/loan = $1.2M ARR

TRACTION

Built, Validated, and Partner-Ready

- ✅ MVP Live at test-app.aetherum.ai
- ✅ DACS API wired & scoring live
- ✅ Staking: 80/20 split, +48% CU yield
- ✅ Patent-pending DACS + $8M SAFE Cap

Strategic Partners

BitGo

Enterprise Custody

Each CU maintains their own direct BitGo account. Aetherum is the software layer only — CU owns custody directly.

Plaid

Bank Connectivity

Check (CRA bundle) approved. Verified income, investment holdings, and account data for DACS scoring.

Sardine

Fraud & Compliance

KYC/AML, SOC 2 Type II. Real-time fraud monitoring powering our Fraud Detection module.

Distribution Moat

Steve Salazar (SVP, General Counsel @Valera) on our advisory board. Gateway to 5,000+ credit unions.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

We're the Only B2B Crypto Lending Infrastructure for Credit Unions

	Aetherum	Nexo / Ledn	DaLand CUSO	Build In-House
B2B Credit Union Focus	✅	❌	✅	❌
Crypto Collateralized Lending	✅	✅	⚠️ Planned	❌
AI Risk Scoring (DACS)	✅	❌	❌	❌
Staking Yield (80% collateral)	✅	❌	❌	❌
60/40 CU/Borrower Split	✅	❌	❌	❌
BitGo Custody Integration	✅	Own custody	✅	❌
Plaid Bank Connectivity	✅	❌	❌	❌
Distribution: Key Advisors/ White Labeling	✅	❌	❌	❌
Live MVP	✅	✅	❌	❌

DaLand CUSO is CU-owned and focused on custody only — no lending product yet. Our moat: DACS + Velera distribution.

REVENUE MODEL

Three Recurring Revenue Streams

70%

of Revenue

Platform Fees

$500-$1,500 per loan

Primary revenue. Charged to CU per funded loan. Scales with volume.

20%

of Revenue

Transaction Fees

0.5-1% of loan value

Per-transaction fee on loan disbursements and collateral movements.

10%

of Revenue

SaaS License

$50K-$150K/year

Annual license for large CUs wanting full API + white-label integration.

+48%

CU Revenue Boost

Staking Advantage

60% CU / 40% Borrower

80% of collateral staked. CU earns $11,840/yr vs $8,000 without staking on a $100K loan. Built into platform at no extra cost.

Year 1 Target: 10 CUs x 100 loans/mo x $1,000/loan = $1.2M ARR | Staking adds ~$2.1M CU income at $50M portfolio

THE TEAM

Founders & Advisors

John Bailey

CEO & Co-Founder

20+ years building teams at Silicon Valley unicorns. Former founder of Thorium Data. Expert technical recruiter — placed engineers at Google, Spotify, Goldman Sachs. Deep expertise in fintech infrastructure and enterprise sales.

CTO / Technical Co-Founder

Actively Recruiting

Evaluating senior candidates with crypto/fintech infrastructure experience. Role covers: TypeScript/NestJS backend, Python microservices (DACS), React frontend, GitHub vulnerability remediation, and ongoing DACS API development.

Advisory Board

Steve Salazar

Advisor — Velera

SVP & General Counsel at Velera. 30+ years fintech & corporate law. Leads legal strategy

Rahul Goel

Advisor — JP Morgan / Uber / KPMG

IT executive with deep expertise in technology risk, cybersecurity, and financial controls. Former KPMG lead on Novi Wallet (Meta's crypto wallet). Also held senior roles at JP Morgan, Uber, ING Bank, and Merrill Lynch.

Saiprasad Raut

Advisor — Worldpay Dubai

Crypto Strategy & Web3 leader. Co-Chair at Hedera Hashgraph. Deep DeFi and institutional crypto expertise.

Dheeraj Nalubolu

Engineering Advisor — Fidelity

Blockchain, AI/ML expert focused on risk management and fraud detection.

THE ASK

We're Raising $1M Pre-Seed

$8M SAFE Cap · 18-month runway · Close: Mid-QTR 2 2026

Use of Funds

36%	**Product & Engineering**	CTO hire, DACS v3, GitHub remediation, API hardening
26%	**Sales & Partnerships**	CU pilot acquisition, Sardine, Plaid, Bitgo marketing partnerships, BD hire
16%	**Marketing & Customer Acquisition**	Demo events, content, credit union conference circuit
11%	**Regulatory Compliance & Legal**	NCUA guidance, patent filing, credit union licensing
11%	**Operational Costs & Admin**	Infrastructure, Railway, partner API costs

Q2 2026: 3 CU pilots → Q3 2026: First loans funded → Q4 2026: 10 CUs live → 2027: $1.2M ARR

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Crypto-Collateralized Lending Infrastructure for Credit Unions

- ✅ MVP live & demo-ready
- ✅ DACS patent-pending
- ✅ BitGo + Plaid + Sardine integrated
- ✅ Staking: +48% CU revenue per loan
- ✅ Velera advisory relationship
- ✅ $1.2M ARR Year 1 target

Ready to talk?

We're closing our $1M pre-seed round mid-QTR 2 2026. We have a live platform, real partnerships, and a clear path to $1.2M ARR. We'd love to show you the demo.

John Bailey
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www.aetherum.ai

calendly.com/jbailey-aetherum/30min
Book a 30-min demo

linkedin.com/company/aetherum-ai

"The credit union that offers crypto loans wins the next generation of members."